

You have 90 days to turn ₹100 Cr into ₹112 Cr.

How to play Investment Banker Mode:
read the market, spend your hours well,
and survive the board.

A simulation game. Every company, index, price, person and headline is fictional and generated by the game. Nothing here is market data or financial advice.

LETTER OF APPOINTMENT

Your mandate

ROLE

**Head of
Investments**

STARTING CAPITAL

₹100 Cr

QUARTERLY TARGET

₹112 Cr

MAXIMUM DRAWDOWN

10%

RISK PROFILE

MEDIUM

TIME

90 days



"Welcome to Apex Capital. Your first assignment is simple. Beat the quarterly target."
Vikram Sethi, CEO

HOW A TURN WORKS

Read, decide, spend time, live with it

The market only moves when time moves, and time only moves when you choose.
Every action either costs hours or changes your book. Everything else follows from that.

READ

Scan the tape

Prices, the benchmark, news, the calendar and your inbox.

DECIDE

Trade or research

Buy, sell, take a block deal, or pay hours for better information.

SPEND TIME

Move the clock

Work an hour, skip ahead, jump to tomorrow, or go on leave.

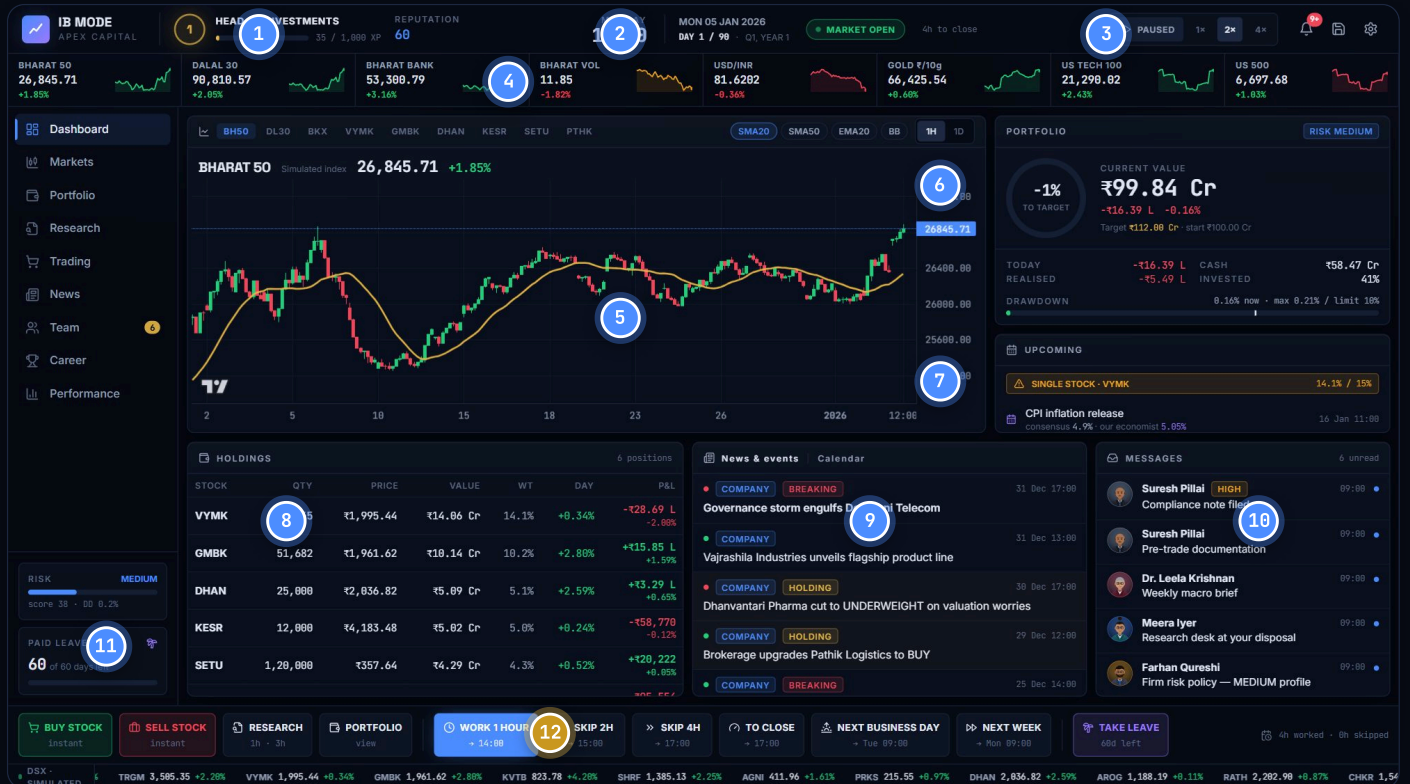
CONSEQUENCES

Face the result

Every hour is simulated: events land, risk is checked, the CEO notices.

Your terminal

Everything you need is on one screen. The numbered pins match the list below.



- 1 **Career bar**
Level, title, XP and reputation (0–100). A warning badge appears here if the board has warned you.
- 2 **Clock**
Day of week, game time, day X of 90, quarter, and whether the market is open.
- 3 **Live mode**
Press PAUSED to switch to LIVE. The clock then runs by itself at 1×, 2× or 4× speed.
- 4 **Live chart**
Hourly or daily candles with SMA, EMA and Bollinger overlays. Each new hour is drawn tick by tick.
- 5 **Upcoming**
Risk alerts, live block deals and the next scheduled events.
- 6 **News & events**
Headlines tagged COMPANY, MACRO or MARKET. Stories about your holdings are highlighted.
- 7 **Risk & leave**
Your composite risk score and the paid leave you have left this year.
- 8 **Holdings**
Position size, weight, today's move and P&L. Click a row to chart it.
- 9 **Messages**
Your team writes to you: macro briefs, research ideas, block offers and warnings.
- 10 **Action bar**
Every button shows exactly how much game time it costs before you press it.

Time is money, literally

The market is open 09:00–17:00, Monday to Friday. One working hour is one game hour, and each hour is simulated as twelve 5-minute ticks. Skipping never skips the simulation: every hour you jump over is played out in full.



CONTROL	TIME COST	WHAT HAPPENS
BUY / SELL STOCK	instant	Market order at the live price plus market impact and fees. Only while the market is open.
RESEARCH	1 h 3 h	Quick look or deep dive; the clock runs while your analysts work.
WORK 1 HOUR	+1 h	One market hour. Counts as hours worked.
SKIP 2H / SKIP 4H	+2 h +4 h	Stops at 17:00, so it never crosses into tomorrow by accident. A new risk warning interrupts the skip.
TO CLOSE	→ 17:00	Plays out the rest of the session, then shows the daily report.
NEXT BUSINESS DAY	→ 09:00	Finishes today, simulates the night (and any weekend) and opens the next session.
SKIP WEEKEND	Fri → Mon	Shown only on Fridays. You get a weekend report on Monday.
NEXT WEEK	→ Mon 09:00	Runs every remaining business day of the week.
TAKE LEAVE	1–30 days	You are away; the market is not. See Weekends & leave .

Blocking decisions. Risk warnings and the quarterly review freeze the clock until you answer them. Reports and dialogues are informational: close them, or they disappear the next time you advance time.

Placing a trade

Choose a stock, enter a quantity (or tap a size such as ₹5 Cr or 10% NAV) and read the preview before you confirm. The preview warns you when an order would break a risk limit.

BUY

SELL

ORDER TICKET · MARKET ORDER

×

STOCK

GMBK — Ganga Meridian Bank

▼

₹1,929.09

+1.09% today

QUANTITY (SHARES)

51682

₹1 Cr

₹5 Cr

5% NAV

10% NAV

MAX

Price (est. fill)	₹1,930.56	impact 0.08%	Quantity	51,682
Transaction value	₹9.98 Cr		Estimated fee	₹19,955
Total cost	₹9.98 Cr		Cash after	₹90.02 Cr
Position weight after	10.0%		Sector after	10.0%

No research on file. Compliance expects documentation for positions above 8% of the book.

Cancel

CONFIRM BUY

The ticket shows fill price, impact, fees, cash after and position weight.

What a fill costs

Order value	₹10.00 Cr
Brokerage and exchange fee (0.02%, each side)	₹20,000
Market impact (≈0.1–1% on big orders)	priced into the fill
Transaction tax on sells (0.1%)	₹1.00 L
Round trip on ₹10 Cr	≈ ₹1.4 L + impact

Impact grows with order size relative to the stock's hourly volume. Smaller companies are easier to move, and your Head Trader's skill trims it. Churning a large book every day adds up quickly.

BUY

SELL

ORDER TICKET · MARKET ORDER

×

STOCK

VYMK — Vyomika Software

▼

₹2,019.45

+1.55% today

QUANTITY (SHARES)

94085

₹1 Cr

₹5 Cr

5% NAV

10% NAV

MAX

Price (est. fill)	₹2,035.76	impact 0.81%	Quantity	94,085
Transaction value	₹19.15 Cr		Estimated fee	₹38,307
Total cost	₹19.16 Cr		Cash after	₹70.86 Cr
Position weight after	19.0%		Sector after	19.2%

⚠ Large order: estimated market impact 0.81% of price.

⚠ Position would be 19.0% of the portfolio — above the 15% single-stock limit.

No research on file. Compliance expects documentation for positions above 8% of the book.

Cancel

CONFIRM BUY

A 19% position triggers the single-stock warning before you confirm.

Research turns hours into an edge

Every stock has a hidden fair value and a hidden earnings quality. Prices drift toward fair value, and results reward or punish the gap. Research gives you a noisy estimate of both. It's a strong hint, never a guarantee.



Quick look

1 hour

- Fair value estimate, wide error
- Momentum, flows, balance sheet
- Results view if reporting within 10 days



Deep dive

3 hours

- Much tighter fair value estimate
- Beat / miss call on the next results
- **Red-flag scan** for hidden trouble

Record a thesis. After any report, write down BULLISH, BEARISH or NEUTRAL with one line of reasoning. The board scores how many of your theses proved right. A thesis or recent research also counts as documentation for Compliance.



Research desk



DHAN — Dhanvantari Pharma

now 12:00
5h to close



DHAN - Deep dive

Meera Iyer · Mon 05 Jan · 12:00

HOLD

EST. FAIR VALUE

₹1,932.35

UPSIDE

-4.1%

CONFIDENCE

88%

• P/E 42.3x · growth 12% · ROE proxy 27% · debt/assets 13%.

Results on 05 Feb 13:00: we lean MISS.

Research is an estimate, not a guarantee. Price when written: ₹2,015.41.



INVESTMENT THESIS · DHAN

BULLISH

NEUTRAL

BEARISH

"Strong growth and improving fundamentals."

Theses are scored for decision quality at your quarterly review.

Record thesis

Q Research another

Buy DHAN

A deep dive: estimated fair value, upside, confidence and a view on the next results.

Risk is part of the score

Apex Capital has four hard lines. Cross one of the first three and the Chief Risk Officer stops the clock until you respond. Cross the fourth and the board ends your career on the spot.



RISK WARNING
 Firm risk policy breached

VYOMIKA SOFTWARE POSITION
19.0%

FIRM POLICY
15%

Farhan Qureshi CHIEF RISK OFFICER
 "This is outside policy. Bring it back in line, or make the case for an exception."

Reduce plan: sell 23,640 VYMK

REDUCE EXPOSURE
 Sell down to policy now

REQUEST EXCEPTION
 Risk Manager decides · 7 days

IGNORE
 Goes on your record

A blocking risk warning with the Chief Risk Officer's comment.

REDUCE EXPOSURE

Sells down to just inside policy (it also works in the 17:00 closing auction). Builds the Risk Officer's trust and a little reputation.

REQUEST EXCEPTION

The Risk Officer decides. Odds rise with your reputation and his trust, and fall with the size of the breach and each exception already granted. If granted, it lasts 7 days. Not available for drawdown.

IGNORE

−3 reputation now, a further daily cost for about a week, and it counts against you at review. Ignore more than one breach and you can't be promoted that quarter.

Compliance too. Buying more than 8% of the book with no research or thesis on file in the past week draws a documentation note. The first one is free; after that each one is a strike (at most one per stock per week). More than two strikes blocks promotion.

News moves prices, and some stories run for days

Every headline comes from a real event inside the simulation: earnings, product launches, regulators, rate decisions, oil shocks, fund flows. Big stories unfold over several days, and how they branch depends on the company, especially its debt. Holding through the chain is your call.



What to watch

- **The calendar.** CPI, GDP and the central-bank decision are listed with the market consensus *and* your economist's forecast. The surprise against consensus is what moves prices.
- **Results season.** Every company reports once a quarter. Expensive stocks fall harder on a miss.
- **Overnight and weekends.** After-hours news and global markets show up as gaps at the 09:00 open.
- **The hidden regime.** The market cycles through calm, bull, volatile, bear and crisis phases. You're never told which one you're in. Read it from breadth, BHARAT VOL and your economist's Monday brief.

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER
CEO CHECK-IN
Vikram Sethi

Vikram Sethi
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

"Strong work so far. You're ahead of pace."

Vikram Sethi
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

"Don't get greedy — the board hates surprises more than it loves returns."

Understood →

CEO check-ins land around days 30, 60 and 85. Their tone follows your pace against the target.

TIME PRESSURE

Block deals: a discount with a deadline

A few times a week a seller offers a large block at 2.5–6% below the market, and the offer expires within hours. Most sellers just want out. About one in three knows bad news is coming.

Take it now

- Lock in the discount immediately
- Risk: the seller knew about a profit warning, probe or product failure due within days

Research first

- A 3-hour deep dive can flag an eager, informed seller
- Risk: the offer expires while your analysts are still working

The trade-off is the game. "I have three hours before this expires. Do I buy now, or spend the three hours finding out?"

Weekends and paid leave

You get 60 paid leave days per career year; weekends don't count against them. Leave taken at the 09:00 open starts today. Otherwise the rest of the day passes and leave starts tomorrow.

09 JAN – 12 JAN

 **Weekend report**

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GLOBAL MARKETS

SECTOR GAPS AT THE OPEN

US Tech 100	-2.78%	Finance	-0.29%
US 500	-2.05%	Defence	-0.29%
Gold	+0.04%	FMCG	-0.68%
USD/INR	+0.69%	Telecom	-1.61%
Crude	\$99.6	Logistics	-2.86%

MAJOR NEWS

"Bulk deals show institutions buying Bazaarbeat Retail"

YOUR PORTFOLIO

FRIDAY CLOSE	MONDAY OPEN	CHANGE
₹100.76 Cr	₹100.01 Cr	-₹74.42 L

Risk: MEDIUM

START THE WEEK →

The weekend report: what moved while the market was shut.

 **WELCOME BACK**

12 Jan → 15 Jan

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Days away

3

Market move (BHARAT 50)

+0.81%

Portfolio

₹100.01 Cr → ₹100.49 Cr

Change

+₹48.13 L

New events

2

Team actions

0

Risk

MEDIUM

Leave remaining

57 days

• Rathmotion Motors product launch falls flat

• No dedicated portfolio manager at your level — positions were left untouched.

BACK TO THE DESK →

Coming back from leave: days away, market move, portfolio change, what your team did.

At Level 1 nobody minds the book. While you're away, prices, events and news carry on and your positions are left untouched. From Level 2 a delegate runs stop-losses at -10% and trims policy breaches for you. Breaches that happen while you're away wait for you when you return. You're not penalised just for taking leave.

Your team, and what their skills actually do

Each character has skills with real effects, plus trust and stress that react to your choices. Ignore the Risk Officer often enough and he stops approving exceptions.

**Vikram Sethi**

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Sets the target and judges your quarter. Check-ins around days 30, 60 and 85. Loses trust when you fall behind pace.

**Ananya Rao**

CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER

Signs off the numbers at review: return against target and benchmark, and the fees you paid.

**Farhan Qureshi**

CHIEF RISK OFFICER

Raises risk warnings and decides exceptions. Warns you early when you near a limit. Remembers every ignored breach.

**Meera Iyer**

RESEARCH DIRECTOR

Runs deep dives. Her skill sets fair-value accuracy and the odds of catching a red flag. Sends a weekly idea on Wednesdays.

**Kabir Anand**

SENIOR ANALYST

Handles quick looks. Fast and quantitative, but his estimates are wider than a deep dive.

**Rohan D'Souza**

HEAD TRADER

His execution skill cuts market impact on large orders. Brings you block-deal offers.

**Dr. Leela Krishnan**

CHIEF ECONOMIST

Beats the consensus on CPI and GDP forecasts. Her Monday brief hints at the hidden market regime.

**Suresh Pillai**

COMPLIANCE OFFICER

Wants research on file before any position above 8% of the book. Strikes cost reputation.

**Nandini Bose**

HR MANAGER

Handles leave and headcount. From Level 2 she brings you candidates to hire.

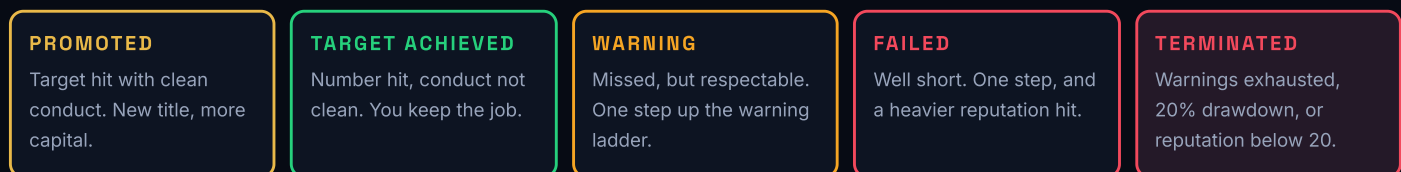
The quarterly review judges more than profit

When the quarter ends, the CEO, CFO and Chief Risk Officer score you on five things. Hitting the number with a messy risk record gets you kept, not promoted.



To be promoted, you need all of these

- Return of at least **+12%**
- Max drawdown within **10%**
- Reputation of **55** or more
- No more than **one** ignored risk breach
- No more than **two** compliance strikes



THE WARNING LADDER



Breaching the 10% drawdown mid-quarter earns an immediate formal warning from the CEO. A good quarter takes one step back off the ladder. If your reputation drops below 30, the CEO warns you before it's too late.

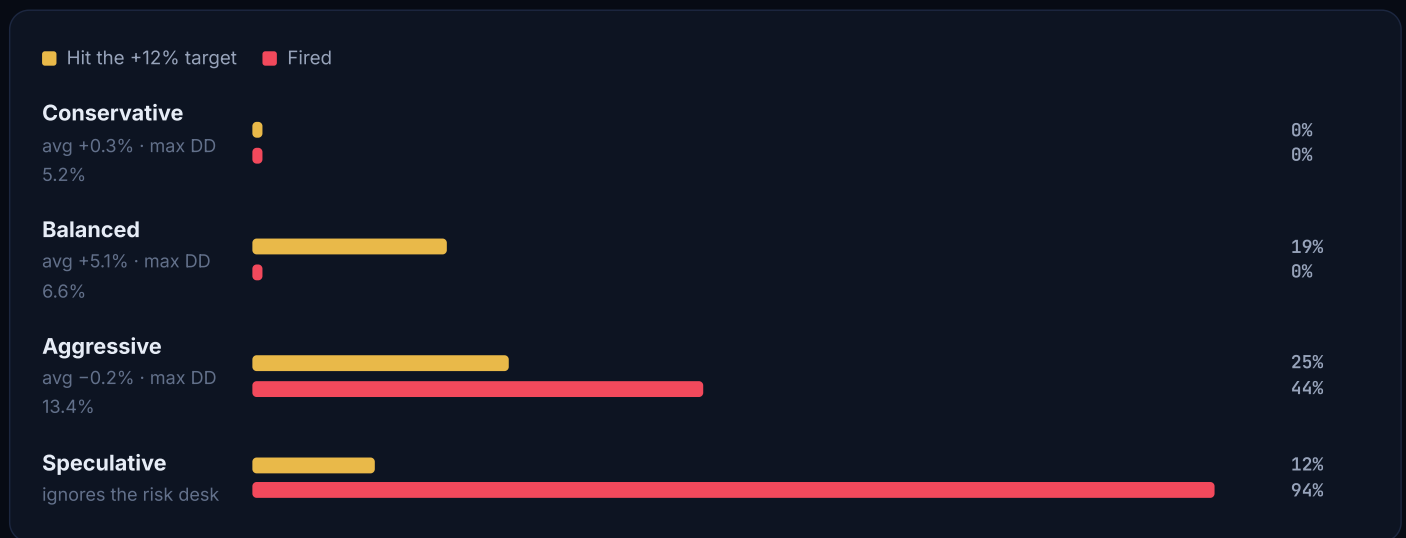
The career ladder

Each promotion starts a new quarter with extra capital, a new target and a tighter drawdown limit. Level 1 is fully built; higher levels reuse the same loop and add delegation and hiring. More instruments are still to come.



Playbook

We had four bot players, each with a different style, play the same 16 markets for a full quarter. No style wins outright. More risk means a better shot at the target and a bigger chance of being fired.



Deploy early, not all at once

Sitting in cash guarantees a miss. Build 8–12 positions over the first week and keep 10–20% cash for block deals and dips.

Research before you size up

A deep dive on anything above 8% of the book keeps Compliance quiet and gives you a real fair-value anchor.

Stay a notch inside the limits

Aim for 12% per stock and 30–35% per sector. Normal price drift will push you over 15% and 40%.

Mind the calendar

Don't sit on a big position through results you haven't researched. Check the economist's number before CPI and the rate decision.

Beat the benchmark, not just zero

Reputation drifts with your daily return against BHARAT 50. In a falling market, holding up well counts.

Take leave when the book is calm

Low risk score, no open breaches, nothing big on the calendar. You come back rested, not wrecked.

Quick reference

Start the game

```
# from the FinSim folder
docker compose up --build -d
# then open http://localhost:5173
# stop (add -v to wipe saved careers)
docker compose down
```

Your career autosaves after every action. Use the save icon in the top bar for named saves you can load later, and the gear icon to restart.

Simulated tickers

BHARAT 50	Broad benchmark of all 20 listed companies; your review is measured against it
DALAL 30	The 12 largest companies
BHARAT BANK	Banking and finance names
BHARAT VOL	Fear gauge; spikes when the market falls
US TECH 100 · US 500	Global markets that trade overnight and drive the morning gap
USD/INR · GOLD	Currency and safe-haven signals

The listed universe

Technology	Akashdeep Technologies · Tarangam Systems · Vyomika Software
Banking · Finance	Ganga Meridian Bank · Kaveri Trust Bank · Shreyas Capital Finance
Energy	Agnivayu Energy · Prakashpath Solar
Healthcare	Dhanvantari Pharma · Arogyam Healthcare
Auto	Rathmotion Motors · Chakra Autoworks
FMCG · Retail	Kesarika Consumer · Nityam Goods · Bazaarbeat Retail
Other	Doorvani Telecom · Setubandh Infrastructure · Vajrashila Industries · Garudastra Defence · Pathik Logistics

Numbers to remember

09:00–17:00	Market hours, Monday to Friday
15% · 40%	Single-stock and sector limits
10% · 20%	Drawdown warning and termination lines
8% of NAV	Above this, document the trade with research
0.02% · 0.1%	Fees, and transaction tax on sells
60 days	Paid leave per career year
1 L · 1 Cr	₹1 lakh = ₹1,00,000 · ₹1 crore = ₹1,00,00,000

Investment Banker Mode is a simulation game. All companies, indices, people and events are fictional; resemblance to real entities is coincidental. Screenshots are from a live game session.